SPIRITUAL REALITY · HEART OF WORSHIP ·
JOHN 3:16 · OPEN · PORN AGAIN? · FUELED

SPRING 2027

Group Leader Content · Southeast Students

2026–2027

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SPRING 2027

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SECTION 00

START UP

EVERYTHING TO KNOW BEFORE YOU LEAD A GROUP

IN THIS SECTION

START UP

Before the first group meets, walk through these four essentials. They set the rhythm, keep students safe, and define the kind of leader we're committing to be.

01 **USING THIS GUIDE** — 1
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WHO & WHAT WE COMMIT TO

FOR SMALL-GROUP LEADERS

USING THIS GUIDE

Every week follows the same rhythm. The left page is your **prep**—know it before group. The right page is your **discussion**—use it to guide discussion.

PASSAGE	The week's Scripture. Read it together before you dig in.
KEY TAKEAWAY	The one idea students should leave with. Aim everything here.
CALL TO ACTION	The response you're guiding them toward this week.
QUESTIONS	**Personal** warms them up. **Biblical** digs into the text. **Applicable** brings it home.
PRAYER PROMPT	Pray it as written, or put it in your own words.
PERSONAL CHALLENGE	A step for students to carry through the week.

01 Facilitate, don't teach. Use more question marks than periods, leave room for silence, and follow up with your students through the week. #leadertip

GUARDARILS

STOPLIGHT GUIDE

SCAN FOR THE FULL COURSE



SE Students wants every leader to promote safety and awareness in tough conversations. Ministry is messy and these topics can feel intimidating—here are the **guidelines for how to best proceed**.

GREEN LIGHT

"Green means go."

You've got this. You have both the Sword and the Spirit.

- Family problems
- Relational problems
- Homesickness
- Heartfelt confessions
- Questions about dating & sex
- Church & theological questions

YELLOW LIGHT

"Proceed with caution."

Mention it to a staff member for coaching.

- Bullying
- Pornography
- Eating disorders
- Drugs or alcohol
- Anxiety or depression
- Engagement in sexual activity
- Gender & sexual identity questions

RED LIGHT

"Stop and get help."

Get a staff member and bring them into the conversation.

- Self-injury
- Hearing voices / hallucinations
- Sexual & physical abuse reported
- Suicidal / homicidal thoughts (threats to harm)

STUDENT TO LEADER: IN PERSON

Southeast takes seriously the responsibility of keeping our people safe. Here are some best practices when interacting with students in person.

PROGRAMMING

- **Keep students in programming.** We want all students in the student room. If a student wants to talk one-on-one, wait until after program and groups end, and meet in a public area where you are visible to others.
- **Appropriate interactions.** Appropriate touches with a student: handshakes, high-fives, and side hugs.
- **When a student's ride is late.** Never leave a student waiting alone—wait with two adults. If you have a parent or guardian's permission to drive a student home, bring another cleared adult.

COUNSELING

- **Counsel same gender.** If a student of the opposite gender comes to you for counsel, connect them with a leader of the same gender.
- **Be visible.** Meet in a public area where you are visible to other people. Never meet in private.
- **Review the Counseling Spotlight.** When counseling a student, refer to the **Stoplight Guide** on how to best proceed in conversation.

OUTSIDE OF CHURCH

- **Pair up with another leader.** When planning an outside activity with students, always include another cleared adult and stay within the 1:25 student/leader ratio.
- **Transporting students.** Never give a student a ride home unless you have another cleared leader in the vehicle and a parent's or guardian's approval.
- **Communicating digitally.** When texting or using social media with students, follow the **Digital Communication Safety Guardrails** on the next page.

STUDENT TO LEADER: ONLINE

When it comes to digital interactions, the following are some best practices to promote safety and create a healthy environment between leaders and students.

TALK TO PARENTS FIRST

Make parents and guardians fully aware of all the digital methods that will be used to communicate with students for ministry purposes.

KEEP IT PLURAL

Want to let an absent student know they were missed, or tell someone you're proud of them? Use plural pronouns instead of singular ones. Rather than "I missed you," say "We missed you."

ADD A CO-LEADER

Adding another leader helps with accountability. Group texting is the preference for all digital communication. At no time should one-on-one video communication take place between a student and leader.

COMMUNICATION LIMITS

Most conversations can wait until the next day—a healthy boundary. Use "scheduled sending" for messages composed outside acceptable hours (e.g. write a message at 9:30 p.m. and schedule it to go out at 7:00 a.m. the next day).

TRACEABLE COMMUNICATION

Apps with a "self-destruct mode" can create dangers when adults use them to communicate with minors. To be above reproach, only communicate with students in ways that are traceable. Never delete a conversation with a student.

HIGH CALLING

LEADER COMMITMENT

Serving with minors is a trusted leadership role. The following commitments define **who we commit to be** and **what we commit to do** so students are discipled, cared for, and protected with integrity.

WHAT WE COMMIT TO BE

01	**Christ Follower**	I acknowledge Jesus Christ as Lord and will keep growing through the Bible, prayer, worship, and community in the life of the church.
02	**Representative**	I represent Jesus, Southeast Christian Church, Southeast Students and will support the church's mission, beliefs, leadership, and unity.
03	**Above Reproach**	I will live with integrity in my words, actions, relationships, habits, and online presence, and will not knowingly misrepresent Jesus or Southeast.
04	**Trustworthy**	I will use my influence to protect, encourage, and disciple students—never to manipulate, isolate, shame, favor, or create inappropriate dependence.
05	**Teachable**	I will receive coaching, correction, and direction with humility. Teachability is part of faithful leadership.
06	**Disciple-Maker**	This is more than a weekly program. I will pray for students, help them feel known, and point them to Jesus and their next steps of faith.
07	**Integrity**	If my ability to lead with integrity becomes compromised, I will speak with Staff and, if needed, step back from serving.
08	**Conflict Resolution**	Following Matthew 18:15-17, I will handle conflict with humility—going directly to the person, avoiding gossip, pursuing reconciliation, and involving the right leaders when needed.

WHAT WE COMMIT TO DO

01	**Serve Faithfully**	I will serve the full ministry year—August through July—and participate in weekly gatherings, leader trainings, and all required ministry rhythms.
02	**Consistent**	I will be on time, prepared, and engaged when serving. Consistency builds trust with students, families, leaders, and staff.
03	**Communicate**	If I need to miss a gathering, event, or serving commitment, I will tell my co-leaders and Staff as early as possible.
04	**Be a Teammate**	I will work with co-leaders, campus staff, parents, and SE Students leadership in a way that is clear, cooperative, and aligned.
05	**Safety Guidelines**	I will follow all Southeast and Southeast Students safety policies and boundaries at all times, including:

- Never being alone with a student in a private or isolated setting.
- Appropriate physical, emotional, spiritual, relational, and digital boundaries.
- Communicating with students only in transparent and approved ways.
- Reporting concerns, disclosures, or unsafe situations to Staff immediately.

AGREEMENT

By signing, I confirm I have read, understand, and agree to these commitments as a leader with Southeast Students. Failure to follow these commitments may result in being paused or removed from serving. If I have questions or cannot agree to any commitment, I will speak with Staff before serving.

PRINT NAME _____ LEADER SIGNATURE _____ DATE _____

SERIES ONE

SPIRITUAL REALITY

HOW DO YOU SEE THE WORLD? · 2 WEEKS · MSM + HSM

SERIES DATES

SERIES OVERVIEW

SPIRITUAL REALITY

[TBD]

SERIES OUTLINE

MSM · WEEK 1	**Love God**	[TBD]
MSM · WEEK 2	**Love Others**	[TBD]
HSM · WEEK 1	**1 John**	1 John
HSM · WEEK 2	**2 John**	2 John

02

Follow up during the week. Students need someone to walk with them, not talk at them—a relationship carried past group can change a life. #leadertip

01 SPIRITUAL REALITY · MSM
LOVE GOD

PASSAGE **[TBD]**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 [TBD]

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

SPIRITUAL REALITY · MSM

02 LOVE OTHERS

PASSAGE **[TBD]**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 [TBD]

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

03

SPIRITUAL REALITY · HSM

1 JOHN

PASSAGE **1 John**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 Read 1 John.

— What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?

— What questions do you have about these verses?

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

04 SPIRITUAL REALITY · HSM
2 JOHN

PASSAGE **2 John**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 Read 2 John.

— What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?

— What questions do you have about these verses?

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

SERIES TWO

HEART OF WORSHIP

THIS IS YOUR SPIRITUAL ACT OF WORSHIP · 6 WEEKS

SERIES DATES _____

SERIES OVERVIEW

HEART OF WORSHIP

[TBD]

SERIES OUTLINE

WEEK 1	**Smashing Idols**	Genesis 35:1-7 or 2 Kings 23:1-25
WEEK 2	**Prioritize Worship**	Hebrews 10:19-25
WEEK 3	**Worship in Adversity**	Acts 16:22-34
WEEK 4	**Focus on God's Attributes**	Revelation 4:1-11
WEEK 5	**Go All Out**	Mark 14:3-9
WEEK 6	**Embrace Diversity**	Revelation 7:9-12

03

Don't read off the curriculum. Know the passage ahead of time and ask in your own words; the less you look down, the more it feels like a real conversation. #leadertip

01 HEART OF WORSHIP
SMASHING IDOLS

PASSAGE **Genesis 35:1-7 or 2 Kings 23:1-25**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 Read Genesis 35:1-7 or 2 Kings 23:1-25.

— What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?

— What questions do you have about these verses?

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

02 HEART OF WORSHIP
PRIORITIZE WORSHIP

PASSAGE **Hebrews 10:19-25**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 Read Hebrews 10:19-25.

— What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?

— What questions do you have about these verses?

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

03 HEART OF WORSHIP
WORSHIP IN ADVERSITY

PASSAGE **Acts 16:22-34**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 Read Acts 16:22-34.

— What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?

— What questions do you have about these verses?

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

04 HEART OF WORSHIP
FOCUS ON GOD'S ATTRIBUTES

PASSAGE **Revelation 4:1-11**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 Read Revelation 4:1-11.

— What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?

— What questions do you have about these verses?

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

05 HEART OF WORSHIP
GO ALL OUT

PASSAGE **Mark 14:3-9**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 Read Mark 14:3-9.

— What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?

— What questions do you have about these verses?

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

06 HEART OF WORSHIP
EMBRACE DIVERSITY

PASSAGE **Revelation 7:9-12**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 Read Revelation 7:9-12.

— What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?

— What questions do you have about these verses?

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

SERIES THREE

JOHN 3:16

IS IT REALLY THAT SIMPLE? · 3 WEEKS · MSM + HSM TOGETHER

SERIES DATES _____

SERIES OVERVIEW

JOHN 3:16

[TBD]

SERIES OUTLINE

WEEK 1	**God Loves the World**	[TBD]
WEEK 2	**He Sent His Son**	[TBD]
WEEK 3	**Believe in Him**	[TBD]

04

Get visual. A big sticky pad and a few markers pull everyone in—drawing or writing answers out makes the points stick. #leadertip

01 JOHN 3:16
GOD LOVES THE WORLD

PASSAGE **[TBD]**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 [TBD]

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

02 JOHN 3:16
HE SENT HIS SON

PASSAGE **[TBD]**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 [TBD]

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

03 JOHN 3:16
BELIEVE IN HIM

PASSAGE **[TBD]**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 [TBD]

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

SERIES FOUR

OPEN

A CONVERSATION ON MENTAL HEALTH · 2 WEEKS

SERIES DATES

SERIES OVERVIEW

OPEN

[TBD]

SERIES OUTLINE

WEEK 1	**Anxiety & Depression**	Psalm 77
WEEK 2	**Doubt & Fear**	Psalm 13; Psalm 27

05 Know your Stoplight. Conversations about mental health can move from green to yellow or red fast—review the Stoplight Guide on page 2 before group. #leadertip

01 OPEN
ANXIETY & DEPRESSION

PASSAGE **Psalm 77**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 Read Psalm 77.

— What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?

— What questions do you have about these verses?

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

02 OPEN
DOUBT & FEAR

PASSAGE **Psalm 13; Psalm 27**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 Read Psalm 13; Psalm 27.

— What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?

— What questions do you have about these verses?

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

SERIES FIVE

PORN AGAIN?

INTERNAL TRANSFORMATION + BEHAVIOR MODIFICATION = NEW CREATION · 2 WEEKS

SERIES DATES _____

SERIES OVERVIEW

PORN AGAIN?

Jesus tells Nicodemus in John 3 that we must be "born again"—but the reality is we have students all across our culture whose most defining reality is not being born again but falling into porn again and again. We want to see the generation entrusted to our care break free from strongholds, walk in freedom, and see the power Jesus has to make them into a brand new creation.

We live in a pornified culture. Things that were obscene years ago are just normal nowadays, and the more saturated our culture becomes with pornography, the more it becomes a generational stronghold. The days of just needing to have a "boys talk" don't exist anymore. One of the fastest growing demographics among new pornography users is girls age 8-14. So we want to have an honest conversation about pornography and talk about it from a Biblical worldview and Christian perspective. Students are going to hear about it at some point, and we want them to hear what God has to say about it—not just a culture that is complacent at best and celebrating it at its worst.

If a generation is going to be freed from pornography and its influence, two things need to coexist: INTERNAL TRANSFORMATION + BEHAVIOR MODIFICATION = NEW CREATION. Legalists can find themselves telling people to simply "stop it." Grace-filled churches can fall into merely preaching grace and prayer while real practical steps aren't encouraged. We want to be a church that walks in grace and truth—so we'll hold these two things in tension.

SERIES OUTLINE

WEEK 1	**Be Transformed**	Romans 12:1-2; Psalm 51:10
WEEK 2	**Do Not Conform**	Romans 12:2; Psalm 51:10

06 Lead with grace and truth. Students who struggle here often carry shame; your calm, unshocked response tells them it's safe to bring it into the light. #leadertip

01 PORN AGAIN? BE TRANSFORMED

PASSAGE **Romans 12:1-2; Psalm 51:10**

KEY TAKEAWAY

What things do I need to ask God to do to keep me from falling into porn again?

CALL TO ACTION

Only the Creator can change the created. All I have to do is ask.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. If you could only ask one person you already know for help for the rest of this year, who would you choose and why would you choose them?
2. When was a time in your life that you realized you couldn't do something on your own? Was it easy or hard to ask for help?

BIBLICAL

1. Read Romans 12:2 again as a group.
   - — What words or phrases stand out to you? What questions do you have about this passage?
   - — Who is the only one who can truly transform us?
   - — How does Romans 12:2 say that transformation takes place?
2. Read Psalm 51:10 again.
   - — Who is David asking to do these two things?
   - — What do you think happens if we try to do the work of changing our thinking, cleansing our desires, and aligning our spirits?

APPLICABLE

1. What happens in our fight against any sin, especially with pornography, if we don't ask God to do an inner transformation first?

PRAYER PROMPT

"God, today would you change my thinking, purify my desiring, and give me a loyal spirit so that I can be who you made me to be."

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Pray this prayer every day over the next week and see what begins to change as you ask God to do what only He can do.

02 PORN AGAIN?
DO NOT CONFORM

PASSAGE **Romans 12:2; Psalm 51:10**

KEY TAKEAWAY

Old habits break when new and better ones are formed.

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. What is an example from your life where it was easy to just go along with what everyone else around you was doing?
2. What are some practical things that you've been able to do to help you resist peer pressure?
3. What is the difference between passive and active verbs?

BIBLICAL

1. Read Romans 12:2.
   - What is the first command or active verb that is given to us to do?
2. What does it mean to "copy the behavior and customs" of something? What are some behaviors and customs of "this world"?

APPLICABLE

1. If our command is to NOT live like this world, when it comes to sexual sin like pornography, what would it mean to NOT be like the rest of the world? Give some practical examples.
2. Read James 5:17. What does it suggest we do with sin? (Confess and ask for help.)
3. We want every student to have a battle plan to fight temptation, but a battle plan without battle buddies is insufficient. Who are the people in your life that you can invite to know what your battle plan looks like?

PRAYER PROMPT

"God, today would you change my thinking, purify my desiring, and give me a loyal spirit so that I can be who you made me to be."

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Complete your personal battle plan and share it with your parents, one friend, and a small group leader. What will you give up, and what will you replace it with instead?

SERIES SIX

FUELED

A STUDY OF MARK 6 · 3 WEEKS

SERIES DATES _____

SERIES OVERVIEW

FUELED

[TBD]

SERIES OUTLINE

WEEK 1	**Fueled by Identity**	[TBD]
WEEK 2	**Fueled by Compassion**	[TBD]
WEEK 3	**Fueled by Prayer**	[TBD]

07

Involve every student. Ask a question for everyone to answer. Don't rush to fill the silence or answer the question. Ask questions of their questions. #leadertip

FUELED

01 FUELED BY IDENTITY

PASSAGE **[TBD]**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 [TBD]

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

02 FUELED BY COMPASSION

FUELED

PASSAGE **[TBD]**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 [TBD]

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

03 FUELED BY PRAYER

FUELED

PASSAGE **[TBD]**

KEY TAKEAWAY

[TBD]

CALL TO ACTION

[TBD]

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1 [TBD]

BIBLICAL

1 [TBD]

APPLICABLE

1 [TBD]

PRAYER PROMPT

"[TBD]"

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

[TBD]

FOR YOUR GROUP

NOTES

NOTES

FOR YOUR GROUP

NOTES

NOTES

NOTES

NOTES

SPACE TO DRAW

SKETCH

SKETCH

Next. Known. Not finished.

Southeast Students